

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 13 Summary

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In this lesson, we focus on **SER**, the other main verb for "to be" in Spanish. You've already learned **ESTAR**, which is used for temporary states and locations. Now you're learning **SER**, which is used to describe more permanent traits like identity, origin, occupation, and relationships.

Present Tense Conjugation of SER (Latin American focus)

yo soy
tú eres
él / ella es
nosotros somos
ustedes son
(vosotros sois – only used in Spain)

When to Use SER

SER is used for:

- Describing identity: *Soy Paul.*
 - Asking or stating who someone is: *¿Quién es? Es María.*
 - Occupation or role: *Es profesora.*
 - Describing relationships: *Es mi amigo.*
 - Origin: *¿De dónde eres? Soy de Estados Unidos.*
 - Nationality: *Es canadiense. Es inglesa.*
 - Physical or personality traits: *Es alto. Es calvo.*
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Articles with Occupations and Identity

When using SER to state someone's job or identity, you normally omit *un/una*:

Es profesora.
Es carpintero.
Es hombre.

But if you add a descriptive adjective, the article returns:

Es una buena profesora.

Es un buen carpintero.

Note: Adjectives like *bueno* change form and placement depending on what they describe (e.g. *un buen amigo* vs. *un amigo bueno*).

Adjective Placement

Most descriptive adjectives follow the noun:

La casa roja.

El profesor calvo.

However, subjective or opinion-based adjectives may come before the noun:

Un excelente cantante.

Una vieja amiga. (meaning a long-time friend)

Some adjectives change meaning based on position:

Una vieja amiga = a long-time friend

Una amiga vieja = a friend who is old

Nationality and Origin

SER is used to express where someone is from and what their nationality is:

Soy de Estados Unidos.

Es canadiense.

Es inglesa.

Some nationalities don't change for gender, only number:

Los hombres son canadienses.

Las mujeres son estadounidenses.

SER vs. ESTAR: A Quick Comparison

El libro es aburrido. – The book is boring (in general)
Estoy aburrido. – I'm bored (right now)

La banana es verde. – The banana is green (color)
La banana está verde. – The banana is unripe

Alive and Dead Always Use ESTAR

Even though they seem permanent, the states of being alive or dead use ESTAR:

Está viva. – She is alive
Está muerto. – He is dead
Los peces están muertos. – The fish are dead

Note on Time and Dates

SER is also used to tell time, days, and dates (e.g. *Es martes*, *Son las dos*), but that will be covered in a later lesson.